

John Damozonio, RHP, Saint Marys

2026 Stats: 2.59 ERA/1.116 WHIP/83.1 IP/87 K/21 BB/4.14 K:BB

6-2, 195

Metrics

FB: 91.2/15.9 IVB/9.0 HB/-5.02 VAA/6.1 relH/6.0 ext/32.1 AA/31.6% zone/38.9% usage/2410 rpm

SI: 91.1/10.7 IVB/-14.7 HB/-6.74 VAA/6.1 relH/6.0 ext/32.1 AA/44.0% zone/9.5% usage/2330 rpm

CB: 81.5 / -7.3 IVB / -12.3 HB / -9.01 VAA / 30.3 AA / 21.1% zone / 10.7% usage / 2860 rpm

SL: 84.7 / 0.1 IVB / -4.0 HB / -8.05 VAA / 31.0 AA / 33.6% zone / 30.1% usage / 2700 rpm

SPL: 84.9 / 3.1 IVB / 8.9 HB / -7.67 VAA / 31.4 AA / 23.2% zone / 10.9% usage / 1210 rpm

Write-up

A durable right-hander with a five-pitch mix and the ability to attack hitters from multiple movement planes, Damozonio profiles as one of the more intriguing developmental arms in the class. Rather than relying on overpowering velocity, he wins through shape diversity, sequencing, and a willingness to throw any pitch in any count. He features a riding four-seam fastball, a heavy sinker, two distinct breaking balls, and a splitter that gives him a legitimate weapon against opposite-handed hitters.

Damozonio also has a funky set up that creates interesting angles, starting on the hard 1B side and stepping across to the 3B side, allowing him to get an unexpected horizontal angle to the plate when considering his high release. While the arsenal is deep, the overall command still needs refinement. Too many pitches leak back into hittable areas, particularly when trying to finish at-bats, limiting the effectiveness of an otherwise well-rounded mix. The ingredients for a quality professional starter are present, but improving strike quality and consistently working to the edges of the zone will determine whether he reaches a mid-rotation ceiling or settles into more of a swingman profile.

The fastball is the foundation of Damozonio's arsenal. Sitting just above 91 mph, it plays well thanks to nearly 16 inches of ride from a high release, creating a steep approach angle that plays best when he gets slight cut to keep hitters from getting the barrel underneath. He generated an 18.6% whiff rate despite throwing it nearly 40% of the time, with the majority of swings and misses coming in the upper third

where the carry is at its best. Against both handednesses he showed confidence elevating the pitch, though he was prone to leaking it back over the heart when behind in counts. The pitch does not possess elite velocity, so continuing to improve his ability to live above the zone rather than through it will be key. The underlying shape grades closer to average despite the above-average ride because the steeper approach limits how much the carry plays. Further, the large frame suggests some velo training may help the long term effectiveness of the heater. 45/50 pitch.

The sinker gives hitters a completely different look from the four-seamer. Featuring nearly 15 inches of arm-side run and considerably more depth, it serves primarily as a strike-stealing and weak contact pitch rather than a chase weapon. Damozonio did an excellent job locating it to the arm-side edge against lefties and running it back over the inside corner to righties, allowing him to generate plenty of called strikes despite only average swing-and-miss numbers. When he stayed below the belt it induced ground balls and jam contact, but elevated mistakes tended to flatten out. The ability to present two fastballs with distinctly different movement profiles should help him navigate lineups multiple times long term. 40/45 pitch.

The curveball is arguably the most visually impressive pitch in the arsenal. Spinning at nearly 2,900 rpm with sharp vertical depth and strong lateral movement, it is a true top-to-bottom breaking ball capable of both stealing strikes early and finishing hitters late. The pitch generated an outstanding 38.3% whiff rate while living in the zone just over 20% of the time, illustrating its effectiveness as a chase offering. Most of his best executions came beneath the zone to both handednesses, particularly when tunneling it off elevated fastballs. It occasionally backs up when left over the plate, but the raw shape is easily above average and gives him a legitimate bat-missing breaking ball. 50/50+ pitch.

While the curveball may be the prettier of the spinners, the slider is the more effective. The slider complements the fastball and curve nicely by offering a firmer look with shorter, later action. Rather than sweeping across the zone, it features moderate depth and tight gyro characteristics, allowing him to attack both sides of the plate. Damozonio leaned on it heavily against right-handed hitters where it consistently finished below the hands or just off the plate away, generating a strong 30.1% whiff rate. He also showed a keen ability to backdoor to lefties, giving him an additional, albeit rarely used, CS

weapon. While it lacks elite movement, its velocity separation from the curve creates enough distinction that hitters must respect both shapes. More consistent glove-side command would further raise the pitch's ceiling. 50/55 pitch.

The splitter rounds out the arsenal and gives him another legitimate weapon versus left-handed hitters. Thrown in the mid-80s with low spin and quality vertical tumble, it consistently finished beneath the zone and generated empty swings despite limited usage. The pitch produced a near-30% whiff rate while living in the zone less than a quarter of the time, showing the confidence to throw it strictly as a chase pitch. Increasing its usage against left-handed hitters could further enhance the profile, especially given how well it mirrors the sinker before disappearing below barrels. The raw movement and feel suggest it has room to become another above-average offering with additional refinement. 50/55+ pitch.